

Nobuyoshi Shimmen

Engineer

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About Me

Full-stack engineer and PdM with 10+ years of experience building products from zero in startups. I take ownership across the entire product lifecycle — from customer discovery and planning to engineering and support — while keeping business impact as the primary compass. Over the past year I've leaned heavily on LLMs for code generation and Dev/Ops automation, shipping and operating a product as the sole engineer. I thrive at the intersection of business and engineering, and I've seen firsthand why good initial design matters when a product scales.

Experience

PLAID, Inc. /PdM/Engineer

DEC 2025 - PRESENT, TOKYO

- Transitioned to PLAID, Inc. following the merger, continuing to own the same advertising reporting product as PdM and Engineer.
- Led PoC for same-day ad data acquisition, partnering with PMM and a key client to design and validate the upgrade from T-1 to real-time data retrieval.
- Organized claude.ai workshops for non-engineer ad operations staff, driving hands-on AI adoption across the team and leading internal validation of new AI tooling.
- Delivered a full data solution for a major retail client — from query analysis to BigQuery data marts and Looker Studio dashboards — enabling data-driven decisions at both operational and executive levels.

agito, Inc. /PdM/Tech Lead

SEPT 2018 - NOV 2025, TOKYO

2024/10 - 2025/11

- Owned the full lifecycle of a new product line as sole engineer and PdM — from planning and client discovery (in partnership with sales) to development, release, and support.
- Built an AI-powered creative generation tool that automatically produces ad banners and copy from landing page content, combining Gemini API and OpenAI API with async processing to generate multiple assets in parallel. (TypeScript, Cloud Run, PubSub, Memorystore)
- Developed a semantic ad campaign search engine using BigQuery and Vertex AI vector search, enabling intent-based queries beyond the limitations of the existing keyword system. (TypeScript, Cloud Run, BigQuery, Vertex AI)
- Engineered an ad performance simulation tool that predicts results for new campaigns based on historical data, directly supporting planning and sales workflows. (TypeScript, Cloud Run, BigQuery, Cloud Scheduler)

2023/01 - 2024/09

- As Tech Lead, spearheaded the full rollout of serverless migration across all ad platforms, extending an architecture pattern built personally. Enabled same-day data retrieval across every platform, establishing a key competitive differentiator.
- As PdM, defined and managed the product roadmap in collaboration with the CEO and PMM, keeping business strategy and technical execution aligned. (Team: 8–10 engineers, 5–6 CS)
- Built a one-click report generation flow using the Looker Studio Linking API, reducing client onboarding time.
- Served as the technical point of contact for enterprise onboarding sessions requiring complex system integrations.
- Shipped rapid beta prototypes for third-party integrations (GA4, AppsFlyer, Adjust) using Google Apps Script, enabling fast market validation with minimal engineering resources.

2018/09 - 2022/12 — Joined the PLAID Group in 2022/10

- As a founding engineer, developed the advertising reporting platform from the ground up alongside the CTO.
- Scaled connected ad accounts from 3,000 to 20,000 and grew daily report volume to approx. 200,000/day by resolving scalability bottlenecks through BigQuery partition design and async processing optimization.
- Migrated the existing GAE monolith to a serverless Cloud Run + PubSub async architecture, improving scalability and reducing operational overhead. (Go, PubSub, Cloud Run, Datastore, Memorystore, Cloud Scheduler, BigQuery)
- Built a data mart generator to link ad data with client proprietary data. (Go, PubSub, Cloud Run, Datastore, BigQuery)
- Developed full-stack web applications including a SQL generator for BI tools and an Excel report generator. (JavaScript, Vue.js (Vuetify), PHP)

(Laravel), GCE)

ubun,inc. / Freelance Engineer

FEB 2021 - APR 2022, TOKYO

- Developed an application targeted for Amazon sellers.
- Responsible for front-end, back-end, and batch processing as a full stack developer.

TVISION Insights Inc. / Freelance Engineer

JUN 2018 - AUG 2018, TOKYO

- Created an internal web application.
- Resourcefully and confidently managed time and projects independently.

Techloco, Inc. / Engineer

OCT 2015 - JUL 2018, TOKYO

- Collaborated in developing an all-in-one marketing tool.
- Proposed and developed an application that allows users to review, comment on website designs on their browsers.

Soldout, Inc. / Marketing Division

APR 2014 - SEP 2015, TOKYO

- Developed Google Apps Scripts, using Salesforce API, and Hubspot API to improve business workflow.

Education

Aoyama University / Bachelor of Business Administration, BBA

APR 2010 - MAR 2014, TOKYO

The University of Vermont / Concentration in Business

AUG 2012 - MAY 2013, BURLINGTON, VERMONT, USA

- 9 month long exchange program through International Partnership & Collaboration

Skills & Interests

Computer Languages

Proficient Level: Go, TypeScript/JavaScript, PHP, HTML/CSS, SQL

Intermediate Level: Node.js

Hobby: Dart, Python, Swift

Infrastructures

GCP

Compute: Cloud Run, GAE, GCE

Data: BigQuery, Cloud SQL, Datastore, Memorystore, Cloud Storage

Messaging: PubSub, Cloud Scheduler

AI/ML: Vertex AI (Vector Search)

Observability: Cloud Monitoring, Cloud Logging, Cloud Build

Other: Firebase

AWS: EC2, S3

CI/CD & Tools: GitHub Actions, Circle CI, Docker, Git

Generative AI: claude.ai, Claude Code, OpenAI API, Gemini API, Vertex AI (Vector Search), LLM Prompt Engineering

Languages

Native Level: Japanese

Business Level: English (TOEIC score 960)

Interests and Hobbies

- Developing entrepreneurial side projects
- Running an independent side service
- Spending time with family
- Studying fitness and working out

Certificates

Udacity/Machine Learning Engineer Nanodegree

2016-2017

Udacity/iOS Engineer Nanodegree

2015

Links

Blog

<https://www.tumblr.com/blog/nobuyoshi-shimmen>

GitHub

<https://github.com/Generalbelly>

LinkedIn

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/nobuyoshi-shimmen-9a8b1a94/>

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